

Internal Linking Audit — The Tank Guide

Site: thetankguide.com · **Repo:** cxchajon/website-fish-keeper **Date:** 2026-07-31 **Method:** Static analysis of every indexable `.html` file in the repo (66 pages), parsing all `<a href>` links, classifying each as **editorial** (in-content) or **boilerplate** (nav/footer/legal strip). Site nav and footer are injected client-side via `/js/nav.js` and `/footer.html`, so they carry no page-specific link equity and are excluded from the counts below. All link counts are **unique source pages**, not raw link instances.

Summary

Metric	Count
Pages audited	66
Orphan pages (0 editorial inbound links)	7
Thin-linked pages (exactly 1 editorial inbound link)	14
Pages with ≤2 editorial inbound links	39 (59%)
Broken / unresolved internal links found	22 unique
Recommended links in this report	62

Cornerstone health (editorial inbound, unique sources)

Cornerstone	Editorial inbound	Verdict
<code>/blogs/</code> (blog hub)	30	Healthy — every post has a "← Back to all posts" link
<code>/store.html</code>	36	Healthy (mostly image/banner links with empty anchor text — see Note 3)
<code>/cycling-coach/</code>	16	Under-linked relative to how often the nitrogen cycle is discussed
<code>/gear/</code>	16	Under-linked relative to how often gear is discussed
<code>/stocking-advisor.html</code>	11	Weakest cornerstone — bioload/stocking is mentioned on 20+ pages
<code>/blogs/nitrogen-cycle/</code>	8	Reasonable
<code>/blogs/aquarium-filtration-for-beginners.html</code>	8	Reasonable
<code>/pages/university.html</code>	2	Under-linked pillar (1,727 words)

Top 5 priority fixes

- 1. `/assistant.html` is a complete orphan. 1,536 words describing the site's AI helper, with **zero** editorial inbound links — reachable only through the JS-injected nav. It links *out* to Stocking Advisor, Cycling Coach and Gear, but nothing links back. Fix from the homepage and both tool pages.
- 2. `/podcast/` is a complete orphan. 701 words, zero editorial inbound. `/media.html` is the natural hub — it links to the Media Library, Community Video Picks, Community Tanks and the books, but the word "podcast" does not appear on the page at all.
- 3. The two biggest houseplant articles are missing from the blog index. `/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/` (3,391 words — the longest article on the site) and `/how-houseplants-grow-in-aquarium-water/` (2,027 words) are absent from `/blogs/`. They currently sit in a closed 3-page loop that only links to itself, so almost no equity reaches them. (`/high-tech-vs-low-tech-planted-aquarium/` is also absent — **intentionally**, per site owner, and is excluded from these recommendations.)
- 4. `/cool-down-fish-tank/` (2,606 words) and `/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/` (1,799 words) are thin-linked — one inbound link each, from `/blogs/`. Both are substantial pages that talk repeatedly about cycling, ammonia, stocking and gear without linking to any of the three cornerstones.
- 5. Stocking Advisor is the weakest cornerstone. Only 11 editorial inbound links, yet "bioload," "stocking," "tankmates" and the "one inch per gallon" myth appear on 20+ pages — including `/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/`, which has a whole section titled "The 10-Gallon Aquarium and the 'One Inch Per Gallon' Myth" and does not link to the calculator that exists to replace that rule.

Orphan pages (0 editorial inbound links)

Page	Words	Note
<code>/assistant.html</code>	1,536	Real content page. High-value fix.
<code>/podcast/</code>	701	Real content page. High-value fix.
<code>/trust-security.html</code>	182	Trust/E-E-A-T page; also the <i>only</i> editorial source of inbound links for <code>/privacy-legal.html</code> , <code>/terms.html</code> and <code>/copyright-dmca.html</code> — so the whole legal cluster hangs off one orphan.
<code>/cookie-settings.html</code>	154	Utility page; low SEO value but should be reachable from <code>/privacy-legal.html</code> .
<code>/journal/2025-10.html</code>	4	Near-empty archive shell, but marked <code>robots: index, follow</code> . See Note 2.
<code>/journal/2025-11.html</code>	4	Near-empty archive shell, but marked <code>robots: index, follow</code> . See Note 2.
<code>/feature-your-tank-confirmation.html</code>	54	Post-submission confirmation. Correctly orphaned — no action needed .

Thin-linked pages (exactly 1 editorial inbound link)

Page	Words	Only inbound from
/cool-down-fish-tank/	2,606	/blogs/
/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/	1,799	/blogs/
/privacy-legal.html	1,566	/trust-security.html (an orphan)
/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	1,488	/blogs/
/low-maintenance-fish-aquariums/	1,355	/blogs/
/blog/holiday-gift-guide-aquarium-lovers.html	876	/blogs/
/about.html	792	/
/terms.html	566	/trust-security.html (an orphan)
/books/life-in-balance/	539	/store.html
/store/	468	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/
/journal/november-2025.html	357	/journal.html
/copyright-dmca.html	339	/trust-security.html (an orphan)
/journal/october-2025.html	256	/journal.html
/community-tanks.html	165	/media.html

Recommended links

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/	/assistant.html	ask the Tank Guide Assistant	In the tool card row, alongside the existing "Stocking Advisor" and "Cycling Coach" cards	High	Fixes the site's largest orphan (1,536 words, 0 editorial inbound) from the strongest page on the site.
/cycling-coach/	/assistant.html	ask the assistant about your readings	Near the results/readiness summary, after the coach returns a verdict	High	Orphan fix; natural next step when a reading is confusing.
/stocking-advisor.html	/assistant.html	ask the assistant about a specific pairing	In the compatibility-warning area, after "The Advisor warns about known problem pairs..."	High	Orphan fix; handles the edge cases the calculator flags but can't explain.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/media.html	/podcast/	the Tank Guide Life podcast	In the "Watch • Read • Explore" block, beside the existing Media Library and Community Video Picks links	High	Fixes an orphan; the word "podcast" never appears on the media hub.
/	/podcast/	listen to the podcast	In the Media card, after "Explore the Media Hub"	High	Second inbound path to an orphan from the homepage.
/blogs/	/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/	Best Houseplants for Aquariums: Selection, Setup & Care	Add a post card in the plants/houseplant group, next to "Growing Houseplants in Your Aquarium"	High	The longest article on the site (3,391 words) is missing from the blog index entirely.
/blogs/	/how-houseplants-grow-in-aquarium-water/	How Houseplants Grow With Roots in Aquarium Water	Add a post card next to "Growing Houseplants in Your Aquarium"	High	2,027-word article missing from the blog index; currently only reachable via a closed 3-page loop.
/about.html	/trust-security.html	how we handle your data and site security	In the trust/credibility section, near the existing Privacy Policy mention	High	Orphan fix; also the only editorial route to the entire legal cluster.
/privacy-legal.html	/cookie-settings.html	manage your cookie choices	In the cookies/analytics section, at "...Support advertising services such as Google AdSense"	High	Orphan fix; users looking for cookie controls land on the privacy page first.
/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/	/stocking-advisor.html	work out what a tank can actually hold	In the section "The 10-Gallon Aquarium and the 'One Inch Per Gallon' Myth"	High	Thin page → weakest cornerstone; the section is literally about the rule the Advisor replaces.
/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/	/cycling-coach/	what cycling a tank actually involves	At "Nobody talked about cycling an aquarium. Nobody explained water conditioner or dechlorinator."	High	Thin page (1 inbound) mentions cycling 7× with no link to the cycling tool.
/why-goldfish-are-misunderstood/	/blogs/nitrogen-cycle/	the nitrogen cycle, explained simply	At "...aquarium filtration, oxygen exchange, and the nitrogen cycle, I realized how unfair that setup really was"	Medium	Reinforces a pillar from a thin page with genuine topical overlap.
/cool-down-fish-tank/	/cycling-coach/	log those readings and check where your cycle stands	Under "Check Your Water Parameters," at "Check ammonia, nitrite, and nitrate, ideally with a liquid test kit"	High	2,606-word thin page; ammonia/nitrite testing is exactly the Coach's job. <i>(Note: this link already exists further down the page — place this one at the testing paragraph and vary the wording so the page doesn't repeat the same anchor.)</i>
/cool-down-fish-tank/	/gear/	air pumps and air stones we actually use	At "An air stone and air pump are simple options for adding water movement and aeration"	High	Thin page → /gear/ ; direct product-category match.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/cool-down-fish-tank/	/blogs/aquarium-heater-safety-temperature-controllers.html	why a temperature controller is worth it	In the equipment/temperature-management section	Medium	Strong topical pairing (heat management ↔ heater safety) that doesn't exist today.
/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	/cycling-coach/	make sure the tank is fully cycled first	At "...forms that beneficial bacteria can process more easily as part of the nitrogen cycle"	High	Thin page mentioning the nitrogen cycle without linking the Coach.
/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	/stocking-advisor.html	check the bioload before you add more	Near "The 'Quick Fix' Trap → Why Problems Appear Later"	High	Thin page → weakest cornerstone; snails are a bioload decision.
/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	shrimp, which we cover separately	At "Shrimp (acknowledged, but covered separately)"	High	The page explicitly promises separate shrimp coverage and never links to it — 12 shrimp mentions, 0 links.
/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	what's happening in your substrate	At "snails graze on surfaces, aerate the substrate, and break down organic waste"	Medium	Real topical overlap (substrate turnover), currently unlinked.
/low-maintenance-fish-aquariums/	/cycling-coach/	get the cycle established first	At "Ammonia is toxic even at low levels, which is why aquariums rely on beneficial bacteria to process it"	High	Thin page with 17 cycling-concept mentions and no link to the Coach.
/low-maintenance-fish-aquariums/	/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	what snails actually need from you	At "Snails need sufficient mineral content in the water to maintain healthy shells"	Medium	Links two thin pages that share the "easy invert" misconception.
/low-maintenance-fish-aquariums/	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	keeping cherry shrimp steady	At "Shrimp rely on proper hardness and stable parameters for molting"	Medium	Natural species hand-off.
/blog/holiday-gift-guide-aquarium-lovers.html	/stocking-advisor.html	let them plan their own stocking list	At "Every tank has a specific 'bioload' and compatibility requirements"	High	Thin page; the word "bioload" appears in quotes and links nowhere.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/blog/holiday-gift-guide-aquarium-lovers.html	/gear/	our gear picks by category	At "Water Conditioners (e.g., Seachem Prime), Filter Media..."	High	Thin page → /gear/ ; a gift guide listing products should route to the gear hub.
/blog/holiday-gift-guide-aquarium-lovers.html	/blogs/aquarium-filtration-for-beginners.html	how filter media actually works	At "Filter Media (Purigen, Matrix, or high-quality sponge media)"	Low	Helpful context for a gift-buyer who doesn't keep fish.
/journal.html	/journal/2025-10.html	October 2025 archive	In the monthly archive list, beside the existing "October 2025 Monthly Recap" link	High	Orphan fix — or better, see Note 2 (these shells may deserve <code>noindex</code> instead).
/journal.html	/journal/2025-11.html	November 2025 archive	In the monthly archive list, beside the existing "November 2025 Monthly Recap" link	High	Same as above.
/blogs/sick-fish-ich-freshwater-disease-guide/	/cycling-coach/	confirm ammonia and nitrite are reading zero	At "...without stressing healthy tankmates or impacting the beneficial bacteria in your main display"	High	10 cycling-concept mentions, 0 links; unstable water is the #1 cause of the diseases this page covers.
/blogs/sick-fish-ich-freshwater-disease-guide/	/stocking-advisor.html	check whether the tank is overstocked	At "Social stress or aggression from tankmates"	High	Overstocking is a named disease trigger on this page and links nowhere.
/blogs/sick-fish-ich-freshwater-disease-guide/	/gear/	quarantine tank basics	In the "hospital tank" paragraph	Medium	Direct gear-category match for a page that recommends buying a second tank.
/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	/cycling-coach/	while your tank is still cycling	At "It affects plant growth, supports beneficial bacteria, and can even shape the entire layout"	High	1,282-word page feeding a cornerstone it never links to.
/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	/aquarium-fertilizers-guide-liquid-root-tabs/	how to dose root tabs and liquid ferts	At "...many aquarists supplement with root tabs or liquid fertilizers to keep plants healthy"	High	9 fertilizer mentions with a dedicated guide sitting unlinked — the single cleanest topical match on the site.
/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	/blogs/nitrogen-cycle/	how beneficial bacteria colonise a new tank	At "supports beneficial bacteria"	Low	Contextual reinforcement of a pillar.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/	/cycling-coach/	track the cycle while plants settle in	At "Many of these plants can be added early — even while your tank is cycling"	High	Explicit cycling mention, no link; page has 6 inbound so it can pass equity onward.
/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/	/gear/	lights that suit low-light plants	At "They tolerate average lighting, handle small mistakes..."	High	13 gear-concept mentions, 0 links to /gear/ .
/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/	/aquarium-fertilizers-guide-liquid-root-tabs/	when root tabs are actually worth it	At "A liquid fertilizer can support stronger growth, but heavy dosing isn't necessary — and root tabs aren't required"	Medium	10 fertilizer mentions, dedicated guide unlinked.
/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/	/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	picking a substrate for planted tanks	At "Anubias grows from a rhizome — a thick horizontal stem that must stay above the substrate"	Medium	14 substrate mentions, guide unlinked.
/blogs/betta-fish-in-a-community-tank.html	/stocking-advisor.html	check your tankmate list	At "Avoid fin-nippers or flashy fish — tiger barbs, male guppies, angelfish..."	High	Compatibility is the page's core topic; the existing link is buried lower and generically worded.
/blogs/betta-fish-in-a-community-tank.html	/cycling-coach/	keeping ammonia at zero	At "Ammonia spikes and temperature swings stress them quickly"	High	Named ammonia-spike mention with no link to the Coach.
/blogs/betta-fish-in-a-community-tank.html	/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/	easy broad-leaf plants for beginners	At "Provide plants with broad leaves — like java fern or anubias"	Medium	Exact species overlap with the beginner-plants post.
/blogs/blackbeard/	/aquarium-fertilizers-guide-liquid-root-tabs/	getting your dosing schedule right	At "Fertilizer timing vs. uptake—when growth stalls, nutrients linger"	High	9 fertilizer mentions on a page whose whole thesis is dosing balance.
/blogs/blackbeard/	/gear/	the light and timer setup I run now	At "Today the light runs a proper plant-first spectrum (no extra white spikes) on a schedule"	High	12 gear mentions; page names specific equipment without routing to /gear/ .
/blogs/blackbeard/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	why my nitrates now run so low	At "Managing My New Problem: Zero Nitrates (The Dosing Life)"	Medium	Strong, specific topical bridge between two plant-nutrient pages.
/tanks/project-tank-000.html	/gear/	the gear list for this build	In the "Quick Specs" table, after "Lighting: Finnex 24/7 CC (custom-tuned)"	High	12 gear mentions on a showcase page; the natural affiliate route is missing.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/tanks/project-tank-000.html	/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	why we layered soil over the plate	In "Quick Specs," at "Substrate: Soil over undergravel filter plate"	Medium	Directly explains a spec the page states without elaboration.
/tanks/project-tank-000.html	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	how plants strip nitrate out of the water	At "Nitrate Starvation: Plant growth is strong enough that nitrates run low"	Medium	Explains the exact phenomenon the page names.
/growing-houseplants-in-aquarium/	/cycling-coach/	see where your cycle actually stands	At "Beneficial bacteria convert ammonia from fish and decomposing organic matter into nitrite and then nitrate"	High	Textbook cycling sentence with no link to the Coach.
/growing-houseplants-in-aquarium/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	how plants pull nitrate out of the water	At "...absorbing nutrients like nitrate while becoming part of your aquarium's natural filtration system"	High	8 nitrate mentions; the dedicated nitrate page is unlinked from its closest sibling.
/growing-houseplants-in-aquarium/	/gear/	grow lights that work above a tank	In the lighting/placement section	Medium	6 lighting mentions, /gear/ unlinked.
/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	how nitrate export actually works	At "For a closer look at pothos specifically as a dedicated nitrate-export tool..."	High	The site's longest article, currently linking only within its own 3-page cluster.
/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/	/gear/	lights and equipment for emersed growth	In the lighting/space requirements comparison section	High	49 gear-concept mentions on a 3,391-word page with zero /gear/ links.
/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/	/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	what pesticides do to snails and shrimp	At "Some of these treatments can be dangerous to fish, shrimp, snails, and other aquarium inhabitants"	Medium	Genuine welfare overlap; also feeds a thin page.
/how-houseplants-grow-in-aquarium-water/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	the nitrate side of the story	At "How Houseplants Use Aquarium Nutrients and Nitrates"	High	17 nitrate mentions; dedicated page unlinked.
/how-houseplants-grow-in-aquarium-water/	/blogs/nitrogen-cycle/	the nitrogen cycle in plain language	At "They convert ammonia into nitrite and then nitrate"	Medium	Pillar reinforcement from a 2,027-word page.
/buying-shrimp-online-process-guide/	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	full Neocaridina care guide	At "Tank parameters are stable and species-appropriate" in the pre-order checklist	High	19 shrimp mentions, zero links to the care guide. Biggest same-topic gap on the site.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/buying-shrimp-online-process-guide/	/blogs/sick-fish-ich-freshwater-disease-guide/	setting up a proper quarantine	At "You have an acclimation plan and quarantine option ready"	Medium	Named quarantine step with a dedicated guide unlinked.
/aquarium-livestock-sourcing-comparison/	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	what shrimp need once they're home	In the opening, at "Fish, shrimp, plants, and snails all move through very different systems"	High	11 shrimp mentions, no link — same cluster gap as above.
/aquarium-livestock-sourcing-comparison/	/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	choosing snails responsibly	Same opening paragraph, on "snails"	Medium	13 snail mentions; also feeds a thin page.
/beginner-carpeting-plants-low-tech/	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	keeping shrimp in a carpeted tank	At "In shrimp tanks, the dense blades create grazing surfaces and shelter for young shrimp"	Medium	8 shrimp mentions on a 2,215-word page, unlinked.
/beginner-carpeting-plants-low-tech/	/aquarium-fertilizers-guide-liquid-root-tabs/	how root tabs feed carpeting plants	At "root tabs can help it spread in sand or gravel"	Medium	Direct dosing hand-off.
/undergravel-filters-planted-tank-case-study/	/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare.html	what trumpet snails do to substrate	At "especially Malaysian trumpet snails—would already be present and could contribute to substrate mixing"	Medium	7 snail mentions on a 2,207-word case study; feeds a thin page.
/undergravel-filters-planted-tank-case-study/	/blogs/purigen/	why Purigen sits last in the chain	At "Coarse sponge / Medium sponge / Fine sponge / Seachem Purigen / Filter floss"	Low	Explains a named component in the flow path.
/diy-freshwater-ump-design-29-gallon/	/planted-aquarium-substrate-guide-aquasoil-dirt/	how we layered the substrate	At "added a weed cloth layer over the undergravel plate, placed dirt above that, and finished with a sand cap"	Medium	10 substrate mentions; guide unlinked.
/diy-ump-lessons-learned.html	/gear/	check valves and pumps we'd trust again	At "Never rely on a check valve as your only flood protection in a DIY sump"	Medium	8 gear mentions on a hardware-failure post with no /gear/ link.
/fritz-plant-fest-2026/	/neocaridina-shrimp-care/	how we keep cherry shrimp	At "including one setup with red cherry shrimp"	Medium	11 shrimp mentions, unlinked.

Source Page	Target Page	Suggested Anchor Text	Where to Insert	Priority	Reason
/aquarium-fertilizers-guide-liquid-root-tabs/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	how plants use up nitrate	At "nitrate is the form of nitrogen that plants absorb most readily"	Medium	Precise conceptual match.
/blogs/aquarium-filtration-for-beginners.html	/stocking-advisor.html	work out what your filter can keep up with	At "lots of plants, shrimp and snails, a light bioload, and one little airstone"	Medium	Reinforces the weakest cornerstone from a well-linked hub page (8 inbound).
/blogs/purigen/	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	where those nitrates come from	At "traps dissolved organics before they break down into nitrates"	Low	Contextual, accurate.
/pages/university.html	/blogs/aquarium-filtration-for-beginners.html	our plain-English filtration guide	Beside "Duke University — Filter Hardware Primer"	Medium	The pillar sends 12 filtration mentions to .edu sources and never to its own guide.
/pages/university.html	/blogs/sick-fish-ich-freshwater-disease-guide/	our guide to ich and common diseases	Beside "UF/IFAS Extension — Health Management in Aquaculture"	Medium	Same pattern — 11 disease mentions, all outbound to external sources.
/journal.html	/blogs/blackbeard/	how I finally beat BBA	At the first "BBA spreading slightly" entry	Medium	44 BBA mentions across the journal, no link to the BBA article.
/journal.html	/aquarium-plants-remove-nitrates/	why my nitrates read this low	Near the "Current Parameters / Nitrates: 5 ppm" panel	Medium	68 nitrate mentions on a 4,906-word page (the site's longest) with no link.
/journal.html	/gear/	the equipment running this tank	In the tank-specs / equipment section	Medium	50 gear mentions on the site's longest page; no /gear/ link at all.
/media.html	/blogs/	browse all the written guides	In "Watch • Read • Explore," at "browse our growing archive of how-tos"	Low	The phrase describes the blog hub but only links to it via an image.
/community-tanks.html	/stocking-advisor.html	plan your own stocking list	Below the featured tank cards	Low	Thin page (165 words); gives it a reason to pass equity to a cornerstone.
/store/	/store.html	(see Note 4 — consolidate, don't link)	—	Low	Duplicate store page; a redirect is the right fix, not a link.

Notes and caveats

Note 1 — Broken / unresolved internal links (reported, not fixed)

Source	Broken href	Anchor text	Likely fix
<code>/about.html</code>	<code>/index.html</code>	"Visit the home page"	<code>/</code>
<code>/about.html</code>	<code>/cycling-coach.html</code>	"Use Cycling Coach"	<code>/cycling-coach/</code>
<code>/podcast/</code>	<code>/stocking-advisor/</code>	"Stocking Advisor"	<code>/stocking-advisor.html</code>
<code>/books/daily-tank-journal-planted/</code>	<code>https://thetankguide.com/stocking-advisor/</code>	"Stocking Advisor"	<code>/stocking-advisor.html</code>
<code>/best-beginner-aquarium-plants/</code>	<code>https://thetankguide.com/freshwater-aquarium-clean-up-crew-snail-welfare</code>	"Snail-free"	add <code>.html</code>
<code>/best-houseplants-for-aquariums/</code>	<code>https://thetankguide.com/reduce-aquarium-nitrates-pothos-guide</code>	"full pothos nitrate guide"	add <code>.html</code>
<code>/gear/</code>	<code>/gear-products.html</code>	"Amazon"	page not in sitemap — verify it should be published
<code>/pages/university.html</code>	<code>/media/</code>	"Media Library"	<code>/media.html</code>
<code>/journal.html</code>	13 × <code>/journal/2026-*.html</code>	various dated entries	Journal entry pages referenced but not present in the repo

The 13 missing `/journal/2026-*.html` entries are the largest cluster — `/journal.html` links to a full year of 2026 entries (Balance Experiment phases, maintenance logs, BBA prep) that don't exist as files. Worth checking whether those were meant to ship.

Note 2 — `/journal/2025-10.html` and `/journal/2025-11.html`

These are 4-word shells (JS-driven, no server-rendered content) but carry `<meta name="robots" content="index,follow">`. They duplicate `/journal/october-2025.html` and `/journal/november-2025.html`, which have real content. Linking them from `/journal.html` fixes the orphan status, but `noindex` on the shells is probably the better call — flagging rather than recommending, since it's a content decision.

Note 3 — Empty anchor text

45 editorial links carry **no anchor text at all** — image/banner links, mostly store promos (e.g. `/pages/university.html` → `/store.html` ×4, `/media.html` → `/store.html` ×3, `/stocking-advisor.html` → `/books/coloring-book-vol-1/` ×3). These pass equity but tell search engines nothing about the destination. Adding descriptive `alt` text on the wrapped image (e.g. `alt="The Daily Tank Journal – printed aquarium logbook"`) is a fast, low-risk site-wide win.

Note 4 — `/store/` VS `/store.html`

Two store pages exist with the same title ("Aquarium Books & Journals | Official Store"). `/store.html` has 36 editorial inbound links; `/store/` has one (from `/neocaridina-shrimp-care/`). This is splitting equity between duplicates. Recommend a 301 from `/store/` → `/store.html` rather than adding links to `/store/`.

Note 5 — Over-optimisation check

No "click here," "read more," "this page" or similar generic anchors were found in editorial content — the site's anchor text is already in good shape. Two patterns to watch: - `/stocking-advisor.html` receives the exact anchor "**Stocking Advisor**" 12 times and `/cycling-coach/` receives "**Cycling Coach**" 14 times. Not penalty-level, but the newer links suggested above deliberately vary the phrasing ("work out what a tank can actually hold," "check the bioload before you add more") so the ratio improves as the count grows. - "**Read the blog** →" appears 28 times on `/blogs/`. That's fine — each card already carries a descriptive title link above it, so the arrow link is secondary.

Note 6 — What was excluded

Nav and footer links (JS-injected sitewide), `/404.html`, `/params.html`, `/store-prototype.html`, `/gear-products.html`, template partials in `/includes/`, and everything under `/dist/`, `/archive/`, `/legacy/`, `/tests/`, `/src/` and `/docs/`. `/feature-your-tank-confirmation.html` is correctly orphaned as a post-submission page. `/high-tech-vs-low-tech-planted-aquarium/` is intentionally excluded from the blog index per the site owner and is not recommended for inclusion — though it is worth noting it has only 2 editorial inbound links total, so if it's meant to rank, it needs in-content links from related planted-tank articles rather than an index listing.